Effects of Fast Fashion

SUSTAINABLE FASHION PRACTICES

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INTRODUCTION

Fast fashion, the quick production of cheap clothing based on the latest trends.
While this makes stylish clothes more affordable, it causes serious environmental and social problems. Dependent on mass production, the industry produces low-quality materials, and fast trend changes, encouraging people to buy more clothes and throw them away quickly.

This issue is important today because clothing consumption increases, especially amongst young individuals influenced by social media and trends. However, many people do not think about the environmental and ethical effects of fast fashion.

Many groups are affected by this problem.
Garment workers in developing countries often face **low pay, unsafe workplaces, and unfair treatment.** Meanwhile, communities around the world suffer from p**ollution, textile waste, and climate impacts** caused by the fashion industry. Consumers are also affected because fast fashion promotes habits that harm the environment in the long run.

THE PROBLEM

Contributing significantly to environmental degradation. According to *Niinimäki et al. (2020)*, the industry is responsible for water pollution, chemical waste, greenhouse gas emissions, and large amounts of textile waste. The Ellen MacArthur Foundation (2017) estimates that around **92 million tons of textile waste** are produced globally each year, with much of it ending up in landfills or being burned, releasing harmful emissions.

The problem is not only environmental but also social. Mukherjee (2015) and Chowdhury (2020) describe how many garment workers endure long hours, unsafe workplaces, and extremely low wages. In some factories, even children are part of the workforce. Many of these workers, particularly women, experience abuse but feel unable to speak out because they depend on these jobs for survival.

local studiess in Davao City show that young consumers are aware of the negative effects of fast fashion yet chooses trendy and affordable clothing over sustainable options.

PROPOSED SOLUTION

WEAR AND TEAR : Sustainable Fashion Wear
A Website Advocating the 3Rs in Fashion (Reduce, Reuse, Recycle)
a digital website designed to educate and empower young consumers to make more sustainable fashion choices.

Key Features
- Educational Hub – Articles, infographics, and short videos explaining fast fashion's environmental and social impacts
- Recycling & Upcycling Guide – Tutorials on how to repair, repurpose, or creatively redesign old clothes
- Thrift & Donation Locator – Information on local thrift shops and clothing donation centers
- Sustainable Brand Directory – A list of ethical and eco-friendly fashion brands
- Style Your Way Section – Encourages individuality by showing how to mix, match, and personalize outfits instead of buying new ones

Target Users
- Students and young adults
- Fashion-conscious consumers
- Social media users influenced by trends
- Beginners interested in sustainable living

Expected Impact
The platform aims to reduce textile waste by encouraging reuse and recycling. It promotes mindful consumption and helps users understand that fashion can be expressive without being wasteful. By making sustainable practices more accessible and relatable, ReWear can help bridge the gap between awareness and action, especially among the youth.

IN CONCLUSION

Fast fashion is a major global issue affecting both people and the planet. Contributing to pollution, waste, and labor exploitation, and encouraging unsustainable consumer habits. Although, awareness is growing, real change requires accessible and practical solutions.

Wear and Tear: Sustainable Fashion Wear offers a technology-driven approach to promoting sustainable fashion through education, creativity, and community engagement. By guiding users toward reducing, reusing, and recycling clothing, the platform supports a shift toward a more responsible and environmentally conscious fashion culture.

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